UNIT 3: EXPLORING CAREERS

TOPIC 3: EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Topic OBJECTIVE: The learner will:

- Understand the relationship between a person's education and their lifetime earning potential

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Explore how education relates to his/her career choices and income goals
- Understand and be able to locate the education and training requirements for occupations of interest

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Think Again DVD/Large Group Discussion

Objective: Students will understand "real-life" connections between educational choices and financial self-sufficiency and success.

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: DVD of "Think Again" (or download from www.commcorp.org/p21), and "Think Again Discussion Guide"

(Note: This lesson will require the instructor to download and burn the "Think Again" video from the website www.commcorp.org/p21 to a DVD (or project using an LCD projector and laptop computer) beforehand as well as read through the discussion guide to select the best topics/questions for their particular class.)

Introduce the DVD "Think Again: The Connection Between Education and True Independence." Explain that this DVD was made by youth for youth, to share their stories of dropping out of school and returning to complete their education and the effect these events have had on their finances and their lives. Watch the DVD (as a group if possible), and use chosen questions from the guide for discussion.

Technical (Mass CIS)/Research

Objective: Students will understand and be able to locate the education and training requirements for occupations of interest.

Time: 30 minutes

Materials: Handouts: "Education, If I Need to Know Where do I go?" and "Career Preparation Worksheet," computers with internet connection, index cards with students Mass CIS log-in names and passwords, pens/pencils

Have the students log on to the Mass CIS website (www.masscis.intocareers.org). Ask the class to click on the left hand side under "Occupations." They will choose two occupations of interest to them, and use the "compare" function to fill in the Career Preparation worksheet. As a final step, they can use Mass CIS and the "Education, If I Need to Know, Where Do I Go?" handout to explore and write down local options to get the education and training for their chosen careers.



THINK AGAIN

The Connection Between Education and True Independence

Quick Start Guide for Discussion with Youth Groups

Objective: Engage the audience to think about the consequences of dropping out of school, examine their own thoughts and feelings about education and their future, and then have a person available to connect interested youths to educational and support resources

Equipment: Think Again DVD, TV/DVD Player, Laptop and LCD unit

Materials: Resource Materials List

Time: Forty-five minutes to one hour

Procedure:

1. Introduce yourself and other facilitators.
2. Show the Think Again video.
3. After viewing the DVD, facilitate discussion using open-ended questions (In-School and Out-of-School lists).
4. Close by distributing the Resources Guide and suggest talking with the Resource Person who will be available to talk with youth after the session



THINK AGAIN

The Connection Between Education and True Independence

Out-of-School Youth Discussion Questions

"You've just seen a group of young people share their experiences on dropping out of school and how they've dealt with that decision. What messages were they trying to get across?"

"Which of the speakers did you identify with? What were the reasons, do you think?"

"Do their situations and struggles ring true for you?"

"What do you think are the biggest reasons people drop out of school? Were there any that weren't mentioned in this DVD?"

"What are some of the reasons the youth decided to get their diploma, GED, or consider college?

"What are some of the fears people have about going back to class?"

"What were some of the financial implications of dropping out of school vs getting a diploma?"

"In what ways does not having a diploma or GED impact the ability to find and keep a good job?

What advice would you give a friend who was thinking of dropping out of school?

"How much money does a person need to make each week to live a comfortable life?

"Can you identify which of your friends are supportive of your education. Describe how they are supportive."

"What kind of work would you like to see yourself doing? What sort of education is needed for that?"

In-School Youth Discussion Questions

What are your reactions to the video?

Which of the speakers did you identify with?

What did the video say are the biggest reasons people drop out of school? Were there any that weren't mentioned in this DVD?

What do you think of the statistic that a dropout earns more than $1 million less over a lifetime than college graduates?

What advice did the video give about dropping out of school?

How much money does a person need to make each week to live a comfortable life?

What are some of the difficulties that prevent people from graduating from high school?

Can you identify which of your friends are supportive of your education. Describe how they are supportive.

If you had to put into words what you learned form the video, what would you say?



THINK AGAIN

THE CONNECTION BETWEEN EDUCATION AND TRUE INDEPENDENCE

Creating Youth-Adult Partnerships that Work

What is a youth-adult partnership?

- A youth-adult partnership is a joint effort where youth and adults work together to achieve common goals. Adults offer knowledge, experience, and access to resources and youth give fresh ideas, new perspectives, and enthusiasm. Working together is a powerful combination.
- Youth and Adult roles have traditionally been defined by the teacher/student relationship. Youth Voice, however, requires that youth and adults define the relationship differently. The partnership is one in which both parties share power and control over making decisions on what gets done, who does what and how.

Tips when showing the DVD and leading the discussion

- Engage more than one youth for this DVD and discussion session so that one youth does not feel like he or she is on display as the voice of all youth. Include young people who enjoy talking in public.
- Select young people and adults who are motivated and interested in working together.
- Have youth co-train with the adults. Establish clear expectations, roles and responsibilities.
- Rehearse a portion of the session and engage youth in critiquing and providing feedback.

Tips for Building Youth-Adult Partnerships:

- Mutual respect is essential; open communication and listening carefully is important
- Provide stipends or paid work experience to compensate youth for their participation
- Have snacks available for the youth; give them time to socialize

Just For Adults

- Provide youth with the information and support they need to succeed
- Youth may need help with transportation to and from sites
- Youth need encouragement; This is an opportunity for youth to develop their leadership and teamwork skills. Recognize their accomplishments.
- Remember that your role is to be a teammate not a parent.
- Have fun

Just For Youth

- Adults may not be aware of how capable you are.
- Do commit time and energy to get the job done
- Adults are often just as uncertain as you are; they have learned to disguise it better.
- Have fun



THINK AGAIN

The Connection Between Education and True Independence

Tips for DVD Discussion Session with Different Groups

In-School Youth

- Focus on immediate concerns.
- What would being out of school look and feel like?
- What would you do in the next few days, if you left school?
- If you are thinking of working, how much money would you make and how much money would you need?

Youth Who have Dropped Out of School

- Focus on future and what positive changes could happen with a return to school or alternative program.
- Talk about real things like earning power, preparing for a desired career, etc.
- Talk about their goals and dreams and then how going back to school could help them accomplish them

Young Adults

- Focus on independence and its relationship to education (more education = more earnings, therefore, financial independence)
- How much does it cost to live on my own?
- Going back to school means I could choose how much money I could make. (I could choose my career therefore I could choose my income)

Youths Who Are Parents

- What do you want your kid's life to look like?
- The decision to go back to school could help shape that.
- Is going back to school (or completing school) worth it if it means a better life for my kid(s)?



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The Connection Between Education and True Independence

DVD List of Resources

Alternative Schools

Statewide:	Massachusetts Dept. of Education	www.doe.mass.edu/FamComm/f_alted.htm
Local:	West Side High School	www.newbedford.k12.ma.us/westside.htm
	Parenting Teens Program	www.gnbcoast.org/agencies.php?id=141

GED Preparatory Programs

Local:	Greater New Bedford Career Center	www.newbedfordcareercenter.org
	New Directions	www.newbedfordcareercenter.org/newdir.html
	Training Resources of America	www.massjob.org/
	My Turn Inc.	www.my-turn.org
	New Bedford Public Schools Division of Adult and Continuing Education	www.newbedford.k12.ma.us/adult_education.htm

Career Information:

Statewide:	Massachusetts Career Information System	http://www.masscis.intocareers.org
	Career Voyages	www.careervoyages.gov
Local:	Greater New Bedford Career Center	www.newbedfordcareercenter.org

College Information

Statewide:	TERI College Planning	www.tericollegeplanning.org/
Local:	Bristol Community College (BCC)	www.bristol.mass.edu
	UMASS Dartmouth	www.umassd.edu
	Southern New England School of Law	www.snesl.edu/
	Fisher College	www.fisher.edu/

SAMPLE



THINK AGAIN

The Connection Between Education and True Independence

Financial Information

Statewide:	Reality Check	www.masscis.intocareers.org/
Local:	Consumer Credit Counceling Service of Southern New England	www.creditcounseling.org

Life Issues

Statewide:	Casey Life Skills Tools	www.caseylifeskills.org
Local:	Greater New Bedford Community Health Center, Inc.	www.gnbchc.gnbchc.org

Housing

	New Bedford Housing Authority	www.newbedfordha.org
	Massachusetts Department of Housing and Community Development	www.mass.gov/dhcd

Child Care

	P.A.C.E.—Child Care Works	www.paceccw.org

Transportation

	Southeastern Regional Transit Authority	www.SRTABUS.com

Substance Abuse

	Positive Action Against Chemical Addition (P.A.A.C.A.)	www.paaca.org
	Seven Hills Behavioral Health (S.H.B.H.)—Outpatient Substance Abuse Services	www.sevenhills.org

Counseling

	New Bedford Child & Family Services	www.child-familyservices.org
	Seven Hills Behavioral Health (S.H.B.H.)	www.sevenhills.org

SAMPLE

Education: If I Need to Know, Where Do I Go?

1. **On the job training**
   This can also be called staff development.

   Training can take place at outside workshops, lectures, or conferences.

   Another worker can train you. Classroom instruction may be included.

2. **Apprenticeship programs**
   An apprentice works with an experienced, skilled worker in a craft or trade. Baking, masonry, plumbing, electrical, welding, carpentry, certified auto mechanics are trades often with apprenticeship programs.

   Training periods last for months or years.

   You're paid while you're being trained.

   Contact:
   Bureau of Apprenticeship and Training
   U.S. Department of Labor
   200 Constitution Ave., N.W. Rm. N-4649
   Washington, DC 20210
   http://www.doleta.gov/individ/apprent.htm

   Local labor unions, school guidance counselors or transition specialists, state employment agencies, employers directly

3. **Vocational Education**
   Specific areas of training, cosmetology, data entry, dental technician

   Technical programs, computers, repair, programming, web page design, LPN

   Trade may have its own school *(e.g. ITT Technical Institute www.itttech.edu)* or it may be affiliated with another agency (e.g. hospital, clinical lab technologies — phlebotomist).

4. **Federal and state job-training programs**
   Many types of jobs are available. Some you have to meet certain qualifications.

   Call the state employment agency for the recent list of available programs.

   Contact:
   Research Administrator, Arizona Department of Economic Security (DES)
   P.O. Box 6123, Site Code 733A
   Phoenix, AZ 85005
   Phone (602) 542-3871
   http://www.des.state.az.us/links/economic/webpage/page6/html

5. **Military**
   Career opportunities in many fields, computers, medical services, business.

   All branches help with the cost of college.

   Don't accept person with felony conviction. You can check after your records are sealed if you have no additional charges.

6. **Learning on your own**
   You can use books, magazines, videos, computer programs and audiocassettes.

   You can also join groups, meetings, classes, seminars, in your community or around the world.

   Libraries — ask the librarian, there are tons of helpful resources and school catalogues. Directory of Private Career Schools and Colleges of Technology.

   Colleges, schools and training centers will send you free information.

   Home or correspondence courses.

   Contact:
   Distance Education and Training Council
   1601 18th St. NW
   Washington, DC 20009
   http://www/detc.org

7. Community Colleges

Community colleges are in a unique position to offer low cost, convenient, personalized associate degree programs. They also offer comprehensive tutoring, guidance and job placement services.

8. Specialized Groups

Vocational rehabilitation

Helps people who have been injured or are disabled. If you were in special classes when you were in school, you may be eligible.

Trade associations or labor unions. AT THE LIBRARY: The Encyclopedia of Associations lists trade associations, professional societies, labor unions, patriotic and fraternal organizations.

Opportunities for women

Contact:

Department of Labor, Women's Bureau Clearinghouse
200 Constitution Ave. NW
Washington, DC 20210
http://www.wowonline.org

Adapted from Merging Two Worlds, 2003

Career Preparation Worksheet

Name: Date:

Log onto **Mass CIS** and review careers that you have identified that may be of interest. Click on the Occupations tab on the home page and click on an occupation of interest and record information on that career on the chart below. Do the same for a second career.

	Career Area	Career Area
Skills and Abilities *Needed*		
Helpful High School courses		
Knowledge *needed*		
Preparation needed [college, technical school, apprenticeship etc.]		
Cost of preparation?		
Locations where preparation is available?		

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